# Module 4 Hands-On Lab

## Before You Arrive — Setup Checklist

### What you need

| # | Item | Why |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Node.js** (LTS version) | Runs the app. npm — the package installer — comes bundled with it, nothing extra to install. |
| 2 | **PostgreSQL** | The actual database that stores the data we'll work with. |
| 3 | **A Google account** | Used later in the lab to test real login (OAuth). Any personal Gmail account works. |
| 4 | **A working internet connection** | Installing dependencies and testing login both need it live during class. |

### Install instructions

#### 1. Node.js

Download the **LTS** version from **nodejs.org** and run the installer. Default settings are fine.

**Verify it worked** — open a terminal (Command Prompt / PowerShell on Windows, Terminal on Mac) and run:

```
node -v
npm -v
```

Both should print a version number.

#### 2. PostgreSQL

Download from **postgresql.org/download** and run the installer for your OS.

- Default settings are fine for everything **except**: when it asks you to set a password for the `postgres` user, **pick one and remember it** — you'll need it in class.
- When the installer offers to launch "Stack Builder" at the end, you can skip that.

**Verify it worked** — open **SQL Shell (psql)** from the Start Menu (installed alongside Postgres). It'll prompt you for a few settings — press Enter to accept the defaults, then type your password when asked. If you land on a `postgres=#` prompt, it worked.

(Running `psql --version` in a regular terminal may not work — it often isn't added to your system PATH automatically. Use SQL Shell instead, don't worry about the terminal command.)

#### 3. Google account

If you don't already have one, sign up at **accounts.google.com**. No special setup needed in advance — we'll create OAuth credentials together in class.

### A note if you're low on disk space

If your primary drive (usually `C:` on Windows) has less than ~2 GB free, no problem — just point the installers at a different drive with more space instead. When each installer (Node.js, PostgreSQL) asks for an install location or

data directory, change it from the default `C:\...` path to a folder on another drive, e.g. `D:\dev-env`. Everything works the same either way.

## Quick self-check before class

- ☐ `node -v` prints a version number
- ☐ `npm -v` prints a version number
- ☐ PostgreSQL is installed and I remember the password I set
- ☐ I can log into a Google account
- ☐ I have at least ~2 GB free disk space